UI/UX Case Study | Newtonite Assignment

Sprout 2.0

Designing a calm, clear first investment journey for first-time investors in India

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1. The problem and the real funnel

Biggest leak: people download the app but never start KYC.

Problem statement

First-time investors drop off before KYC because they feel unprepared (PAN and Aadhaar not ready) and unsure (investing feels scary, and the waiting screen looks like a crash).

40,000 downloads	Starting point. Includes paid-ad installs, so intent is mixed.
9,000 start KYC	22.5% of downloads. Biggest leak: 77.5% never start KYC.
3,000 first investments	33% of KYC starters, only 7.5% of downloads.

Bars are illustrative, not to scale.

91%

of users are on mobile, so design is mobile-first

62%

KYC drop-off, cause unknown; Support complaints give strong clues

65%

say investing feels scary (survey of 40 existing users, directional only)

2. Data audit: what I trusted and what I questioned

Every number has a flaw. I name it and state my assumption.

Metric	What it says	Why it may be wrong	My assumption
78% bounce	Most visitors leave the homepage at once	Includes a paid ad campaign, so low-intent traffic inflates it	Upper bound only. Judge organic traffic separately
62% KYC drop-off	Most people who start KYC do not finish	Cause unknown. Also differs from the funnel (9,000 to 3,000 is a 67% gap)	Support clues (PAN/Aadhaar not ready, wait screen looks like a crash) are the main cause
91% mobile	Phones are the main device	Likely reliable analytics data	Mobile-first, desktop adapted after
40% phones under ₹10,000	Many low-end devices	Price is inferred, not measured exactly	Light page, SVG mascot, no video
6.2 s load on 4G	The page is slow	Measured on 4G only; worse on weaker networks	Performance is a design problem: page under 1.5 MB
65% say investing feels scary	Fear blocks starting	Survey n=40, existing users only; misses people who dropped off	Directional only. Design for calm, do not claim the size
"Many" prefer Hindi	Hindi matters	No number was given	Hindi-ready layout (labels 30% longer). No over-claiming

3. Users and journey

Two lightweight personas and the six-step path from ad to first ₹100.

Riya, 22, fresher

₹8,000 phone, 4G, English and Hindi. Wants to start with ₹100.

Fears losing money and doing paperwork wrong. Needs clear steps and a time estimate.

Sunita, 38, small town

First-time investor, prefers Hindi, shared family phone.

Worried about entering Aadhaar details. Needs a reason for every question.

Journey map

Ad or search	Homepage	Download	Onboarding	KYC	First ₹100
Curious	Doubtful: is this for me?	Hopeful	Slightly anxious	Nervous, effortful	Relieved, proud
78% bounce (inflated by paid a	Needs one clear message and	Biggest leak: download to KYC	Not ready with PAN/Aadhaar	Why are you asking this?	Waiting screen looks like a cra

4. Stakeholder conflicts: my decisions

I chose and justified instead of saying yes to everyone.

Who	Asks for	Conflicts with	My decision	Reason
CEO	Minimal, premium, no cartoon	Marketing mascot	Abstract, geometric leaf mascot used sparingly as a guide	65% say investing feels scary; a calm guide builds trust without looking childish
Head of Marketing	Mascot, video, live ticker, 3 pop-ups, referral banner	Dev, CEO, load time	Keep the mascot. Drop video, ticker and pop-ups. Move referral to after the first investment	6.2 s load, 40% low-end phones; pop-ups hurt mobile UX and trust
Compliance	12px+ disclaimer above the fold, no banned words	Clean hero	Disclaimer built into the hero as a styled strip. Words: start small, regulated, you stay in control	Non-negotiable legal requirement
Lead Developer	Under 1.5 MB, animations under 100 KB, 1 dev, 3 weeks	Marketing extras	Reusable components, SVG mascot, one web font, 6 core screens	The 3-week launch is fixed
Customer Support	Users not ready with PAN/ Aadhaar; waiting screen looks like a crash	None (supports KYC fix)	"Keep these ready" on homepage and onboarding screen 2. Animated wait screen with time estimate	Directly targets the KYC drop-off

5. Mascot and visual direction

Sprout, the guide: friendly enough for Marketing, restrained enough for the CEO.



Welcome



Explaining



Waiting



Celebrating

Why a leaf

A sprout is a natural symbol of starting small. Simple geometric shapes keep it premium (CEO). A face and four emotions give Marketing a character. It appears only at key moments.

Palette (AA checked)

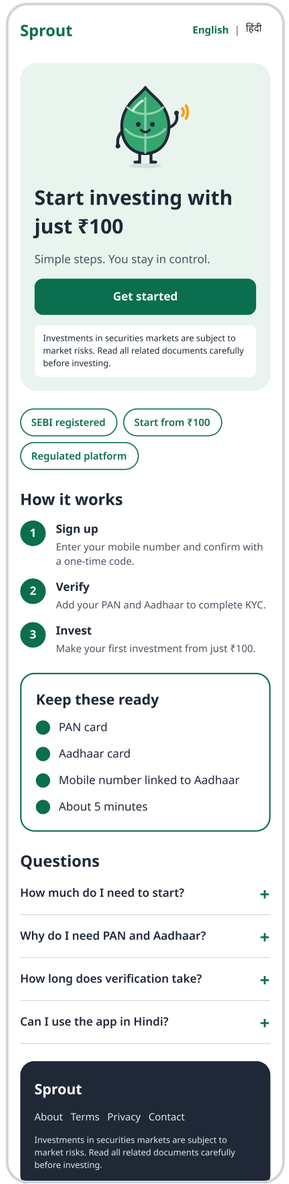
Green #0B6E4F: white text 6.3:1. Mint #E8F5EE: green text 5.5:1. Charcoal #1F2937: 14.7:1 on white. Amber #F59E0B: small accents only, charcoal text 7:1, never white text.

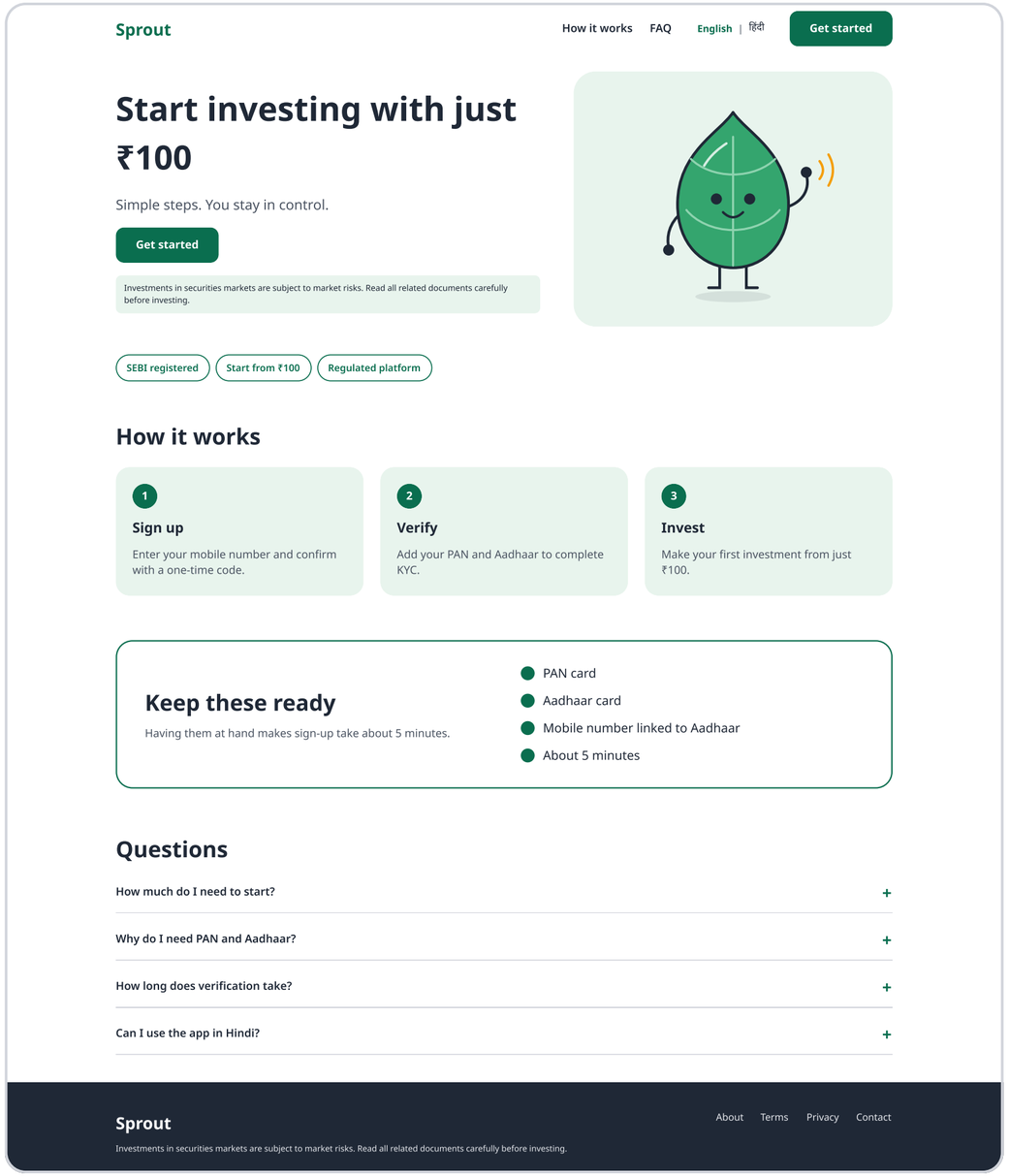
How it is built

Each state is one SVG, about 1.5 KB. Noto Sans (supports Devanagari for Hindi later). 8px spacing grid. If animated, a Lottie would stay under 100 KB.

6. Homepage: mobile first, desktop adapted

One message, one button, disclaimer visible without scrolling.





Design rationale

• Hero: one headline, one CTA, mascot as a calm guide.

• 12px risk disclaimer inside the hero, above the fold on every screen size.

• Trust signals: SEBI registered, start from ₹100, regulated.

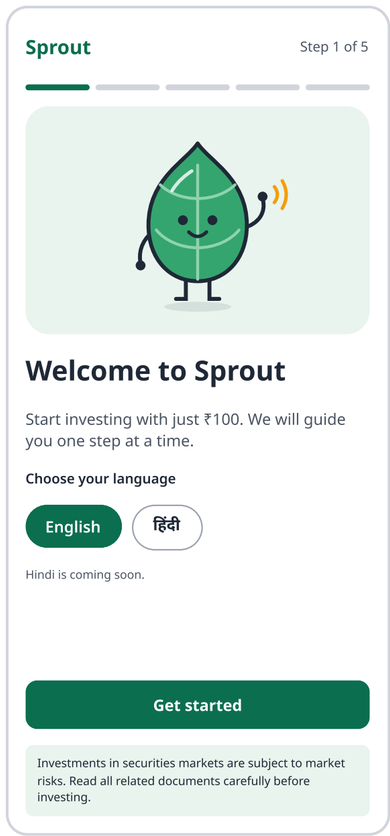
• "Keep PAN + Aadhaar ready" checklist answers the top Support complaint.

• No video, ticker, pop-ups or referral banner: protects the 1.5 MB limit and the 3-week launch.

• Same colours, mascot and tone continue into onboarding.

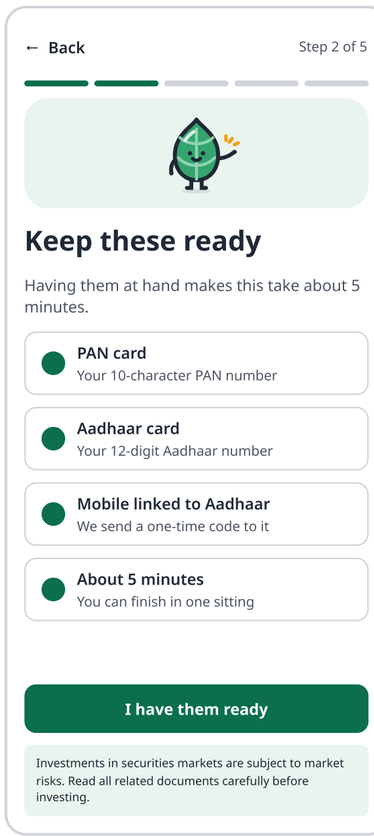
7. Onboarding: five screens, one story

Same mascot, colours and tone from the homepage to the waiting screen.



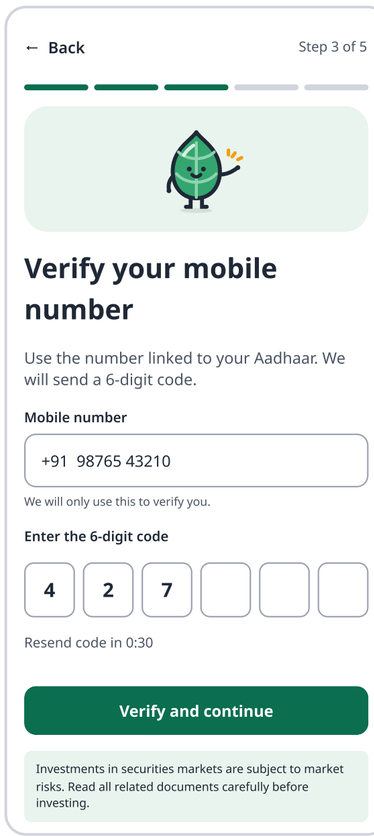
1. Welcome

Mascot introduces Sprout and the ₹100 start. Language choice prepares for Hindi.



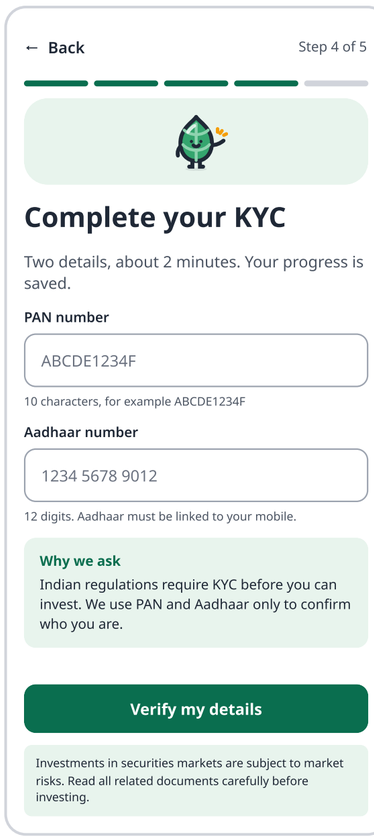
2. What you need

Fixes the main KYC blocker: PAN and Aadhaar not ready.



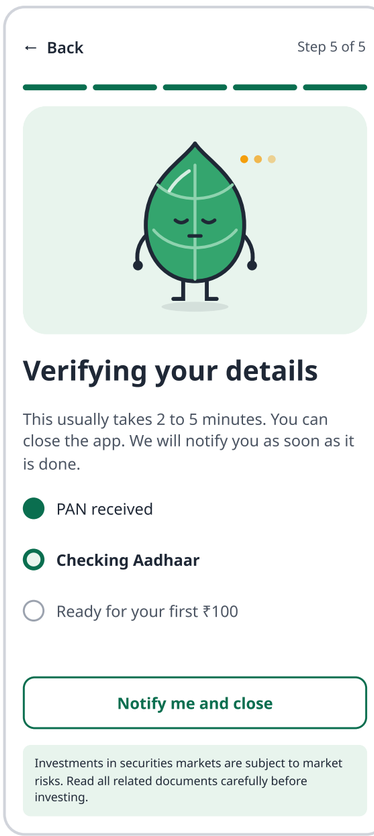
3. Mobile and OTP

Big inputs, 44px+ targets, 6-digit code with resend timer.



4. KYC

Two fields, progress bar and a "Why we ask" note to reduce fear.



5. Verification wait

Mascot, time estimate and "we will notify you", so it never looks like a crash.

8. Success metrics and page-weight estimate

Targets are my assumptions, to be validated with real data.

Success metrics

Metric	Today	Target (assumed)
Download to KYC start	22.5%	30%
KYC completion	Unknown (62% drop-off)	Measure, then improve
Time to first investment	Not given	Under 10 minutes
Wait-screen abandonment	Unknown	Track and reduce
Organic homepage bounce	78% blended	Track separately

Page-weight estimate (homepage)

Item	Estimate
HTML and CSS	about 30 KB
JavaScript	about 150 to 200 KB
Noto Sans, 2 weights, subset	about 60 KB
Mascot SVG (4 states)	about 6 KB
Icons and images	about 100 KB
Total	about 350 to 400 KB (limit 1.5 MB)

9. What I would test next

Questions this design cannot answer yet.

A/B test the waiting screen	Time estimate and mascot versus a plain spinner. Measure abandonment during verification.
Survey people who dropped off	The n=40 survey only covers existing users. Ask drop-offs why they left before or during KYC.
Test "Keep these ready" placement	Homepage only, onboarding screen 2 only, or both. Measure KYC start rate.
Hindi layout test	Check labels about 30% longer on a ₹8,000 phone, and test Hindi copy with real users.
Moderated usability test	Five first-time investors on low-end phones. Watch where they hesitate in KYC.

Tools: Figma, with Figma AI used for first-draft layouts. Decisions, reasoning and edits are mine.